

Research Participant Information

Maze of Instruction: Learning to Recognize
the Cardinal Directions in Chinese

Christos Mousas
Department of Computer and Information Technology
Purdue University

Key Information

You are being asked to participate in a research study. Your participation is voluntary, and you may choose to cease participating at any time. If you decide to take part in the study, you will be asked to sign this form. Please read this form before agreeing to participate. Be sure you understand what you will need to do, as well as any possible risks or benefits. You may contact the research team with any questions you may have. This study is only intended for people who are 18 years of age or older. Please do not complete the study if you are not legally considered an adult.

The research team is studying how to use computer applications to teach a small number of Chinese words to people who have little to no experience with the Chinese language. The researchers hope to use their findings from this study in a larger educational game project. You are being asked to participate in this study because your fresh perspective will help the researchers understand the strengths and weaknesses of the application's design.

What Will I Do if I Choose to Participate in This Study?

If you choose to participate in this study, you will be asked to do the following:

1. Take a short pre-test
2. Interact with one of two educational computer applications
3. Send us your save file
4. Take a short post-test and survey

The pre-test and post-test will test your Chinese knowledge before and after using the application to help measure whether the design of the application was successful. The survey will ask about what you experienced while interacting with it. The 'save file' will include a record of your in-application progress, including the buttons you pressed and how quickly you finished each stage.

How Long Will I Be in the Study?

We expect the study to take approximately 30 minutes.

What Equipment Will I Need?

You will need a Mac or Windows laptop or desktop computer. Do not attempt to do this study using only a mobile phone. Your computer must be capable of running the application for you to participate. Not all machines will be capable of running the application.

You will need to be able to hear the application in order to participate. This means you will need speakers or headphones that are compatible with your computer.

You will need to download, run, and interact with the educational application on your computer. Afterward, you will need to send us your save file. You will not need to install any software. You can delete the entire application after you have completed the study by deleting the files you downloaded for it.

What Are the Possible Risks or Discomforts?

All research carries the risk of breach of confidentiality, which is the risk that someone outside of our study could figure out that you were in the study or that information recorded was yours. We will take steps to minimize that risk including using identification numbers assigned by Qualtrics rather than names to identify participants, anonymizing information after data collection for the study has concluded, and refraining from collecting personally identifying information.

This study is designed to evaluate the qualities of the educational application, not to evaluate your personal learning or language ability. However, learning a new skill can be stressful. Some participants may feel discomfort while taking part in the pre- and post-test. Some participants may experience frustration or other negative emotions while interacting with the application. If you feel uncomfortable, you may cease participation in the study at any time. We anticipate that the risks of participating in this research are no greater than what you would encounter in daily life or during the performance of routine physical or psychological examinations or tests.

Are There Any Potential Benefits?

Studies have suggested that learning a new language is good for one's cognitive health. This study will introduce you to a small number of new words in a foreign language.

By the end of the study, you may be able to use those words to understand very basic directions given to you in a new language. If you find this empowering, inspiring, or interesting, it may help encourage you to try learning a new language. Our research team is experimenting with teaching in different ways. If a style of learning is new to you, it may broaden your awareness of alternative approaches to learning and teaching new skills and information.

Will I Receive Payment or Other Incentives?

We are not presently able to offer payment or other incentives in exchange for your participation. If you choose to participate, we thank you for your time.

Will Information About Me and My Participation Be Kept Confidential?

The research team plans to collect your survey responses through the online research platform Qualtrics. This data will be stored in locked physical storage or secured electronic storage. The project's research records may be reviewed by departments at Purdue University responsible for regulatory and research oversight.

The research team plans to keep the answers from this study to answer research questions. The team will keep this information until after the study is completed (approximately six months) and for at least three years after it is finished. We will anonymize the data during the study. To anonymize it, we will remove the ID numbers provided by Qualtrics. We may share the anonymous data and findings with other researchers or in research papers or presentations.

If required by law, information you share with us may be shared outside the research study. We also may need to share research records with other groups for quality assurance or data analysis. These groups include the Purdue University Institutional Review Board or its designees, and state or federal agencies who may need to access the research records (as allowed by law).

What are My Rights if I Take Part in This Study?

You do not have to participate in this research project. If you agree to participate, you may withdraw your consent at any time, without penalty, by contacting a member of the research team. Please make sure you know your Qualtrics ID number.

Because data from this survey will be anonymized after collection to better protect your privacy, and the Qualtrics ID numbers will eventually be removed, there will come a point in the study where we may no longer be able to distinguish your responses from those of other participants. We will not be able to provide information about your answers, or remove them, at this point.

Participants who provide conflicting or verifiably false answers about themselves, or who do not appear to have filled in the questionnaires in good faith, may have their participation terminated by the researcher without the participant's consent.

The decision to participate or not in the research will have no effect, positive or negative, on the participant's relationship with any of the researchers involved with the study.

Who Can I Contact if I Have Questions About the Study?

If you have questions, comments, or concerns about this research project, you can talk to one of the researchers. Please contact Melissa Kronenberger (kronenbm@purdue.edu) as the first point of contact, or you can contact the principal investigator, Christos Mousas (cmousas@purdue.edu).

If you have questions about your rights while taking part in the study or have concerns about the treatment of research participants, please call the Human Research Protection Program at (765) 494-5942, email (irb@purdue.edu) or write to: Human Research Protection Program - Purdue University Ernest C. Young Hall, Room 1010 155 S. Grant St. West Lafayette, IN 47907-2114. To report anonymously via Purdue's Hotline, see www.purdue.edu/hotline